

Interview with Fabiola Navarro, Sr. Product Advisor, Field Readiness - India Research - 9th July 2025

Interviewee: Fabiola Navarro - Sr. Product Advisor, Field Readiness

00:00:01.010 --> 00:00:01.930

Fabiola Navarro: If it's

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00:00:02.120 --> 00:00:18.110

Fabiola Navarro: helpful. And I was even trying to pull up some of my old because I had a I've had a couple projects before my product advisor days, where India was in scope, and I had one my actual last project before I moved into this role. They did have Indian scope, and so theirs is like pretty fresh

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00:00:18.475 --> 00:00:22.729

Fabiola Navarro: but like one of the things that we always see when India is in scope is

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00:00:23.230 --> 00:00:30.130

Fabiola Navarro: the offer compensation process. You maybe have even heard about this already. But, I did find

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00:00:30.380 --> 00:00:33.859

Fabiola Navarro: a somewhat good screenshot just to kind of give you an idea

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00:00:34.040 --> 00:00:37.100

Fabiola Navarro: of what we would have to configure in the offer letters.

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00:00:37.480 --> 00:00:39.379

Fabiola Navarro: Let me see if I can pull that up.

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00:00:41.290 --> 00:00:43.610

Fabiola Navarro: And this is like part of a

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00:00:44.510 --> 00:00:48.299

Fabiola Navarro: a change request. So we had to keep making updates because they're

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00:00:48.790 --> 00:01:00.449

Fabiola Navarro: compensation was so complex, so like, in addition to what they would see in the offer details they would have to, they would require us to do more calculations, have more information given to the candidate.

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00:01:00.570 --> 00:01:02.859

David Denham: So you can see here.

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00:01:03.000 --> 00:01:30.989

Fabiola Navarro: We had to include a table, so they were always a fan of the tables, and we had to pull in, you know, compensation grade fixed cost, variable costs, basic like all these different ways and formulas, I guess that we had to create so it required a ton, a ton of Calc fields, and you can even see even just the fact that this is a change request right? Sometimes we didn't get it right. We had to go back and forth, kind of design it with them.

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00:01:31.160 --> 00:01:40.339

Fabiola Navarro: but they had a ton of pieces that needed to be included as part of their offer. And technically, this is like

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00:01:40.660 --> 00:01:46.379

Fabiola Navarro: part of their and a separate document that goes out with the offer letter

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00:01:46.510 --> 00:01:52.940

Fabiola Navarro: with this level of detail. So we were basically generating 2 documents for the candidate.

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00:01:53.330 --> 00:01:55.130

David Denham: Okay, at least. Yeah.

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00:01:55.390 --> 00:01:57.639

David Denham: And is that a is that a legal requirement? There.

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00:01:58.250 --> 00:02:04.180

Fabiola Navarro: I believe. So. Yeah, so they had like a lot for every candidate. The candidate always received this.

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00:02:04.669 --> 00:02:12.640

Fabiola Navarro: So I would assume that it was, it was legally required to provide that information in this level of detail. Yeah.

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00:02:13.350 --> 00:02:17.090

Fabiola Navarro: and let me see if there was a little more detail down here.

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00:02:17.750 --> 00:02:28.269

Fabiola Navarro: but we had to basically create those calculated fields or formulas from scratch. I'll see if I can find a little bit more on the actual calculus behind it, but it like

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00:02:28.270 --> 00:02:29.709

Fabiola Navarro: you can see it's just a lot

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00:02:31.030 --> 00:02:36.640

Fabiola Navarro: And then the other one is, and let me make sure that I'm

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00:02:37.520 --> 00:02:44.479

Fabiola Navarro: maybe going in order with the the list. I I gave you. The other one, I believe, was like the start date.

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00:02:45.510 --> 00:02:50.938

Fabiola Navarro: Let me just check yes, start date. So these guys

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00:02:53.810 --> 00:03:13.059

Fabiola Navarro: they were using like auto completion of the hire. They were also using automatic stage routing. They were using basically any automation that we had. They wanted it so and and they wanted to have the start date change or start date be confirmed before

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00:03:13.360 --> 00:03:27.300

Fabiola Navarro: the hire was completed, and because we were auto completing the hire, that kind of took away that 3rd spot to Co. To actually do that confirmation. So I think what they ended up doing is building an extend

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00:03:27.450 --> 00:03:34.830

Fabiola Navarro: form that basically recreated like the start change, start date, change process.

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00:03:35.150 --> 00:03:39.590

Fabiola Navarro: and it kind of simplified it for them and brought it up when it they needed it in the process.

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00:03:41.090 --> 00:03:47.919

Fabiola Navarro: I was trying to find some notes on that one, too, because it was also something that came up a little bit later in the project. Let me see if I can.

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00:03:47.920 --> 00:03:51.970

David Denham: Interesting, and was that something that happened frequently, that the

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00:03:52.130 --> 00:03:59.010

David Denham: the start date would change before the and the higher, and

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00:03:59.310 --> 00:04:03.210

David Denham: that'd be something they need to do in like high volumes, or something like that, or.

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00:04:03.210 --> 00:04:07.040

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah. Yeah. And and even outside of India, like, we

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00:04:07.100 --> 00:04:34.229

Fabiola Navarro: always have that conversation, because sometimes that determines that we're gonna turn on auto complete hire or not, because we'll say right. The 1st time is Job Rec. At that point you don't really know. Second time is offer, and then at the point of higher. So if they have a ton of changes, we'll be like, maybe you consider not auto completing the hire, but in their case they were like, no, we we rather have it. It does happen a lot, but we rather have that taking off and completing to kind of get things moving.

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00:04:34.922 --> 00:04:37.950

Fabiola Navarro: But I would say, yes, I feel like that is

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00:04:38.700 --> 00:04:42.540

Fabiola Navarro: something that that was common for them, and I'm trying to find the number.

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00:04:43.560 --> 00:05:09.460

David Denham: Yeah, no worries. So so just so, I understand. Like they, they've obviously automated as much as they can up until the end of the process before the hire, and then the the start day frequently changes. So are they doing like some sort of a mass change. Then, using this extend form that they they built. Is it like for multiple candidates, they're they're doing this, or is it just kind of per per candidate with whatever they built there. Do you know.

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00:05:09.690 --> 00:05:11.689

Fabiola Navarro: I? Yeah, I don't know.

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00:05:13.580 --> 00:05:16.879

Fabiola Navarro: Let me see. Maybe if it says it here, I would think it's like

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00:05:18.510 --> 00:05:23.359

Fabiola Navarro: in mass. Let me see. So

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00:05:30.990 --> 00:05:38.530

Fabiola Navarro: India background to kick off only after. So this is more on this, the other one that I was gonna tell you about. Okay. So here's 1.

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00:05:41.540 --> 00:05:45.149

David Denham: And oh, I forgot to ask who's the who's the customer? I don't know if you'd be able to share.

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00:05:45.150 --> 00:05:47.170

Fabiola Navarro: Oh, I'm sorry. Yeah. It was Lowe's.

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00:05:47.360 --> 00:05:48.070

David Denham: No, it's okay.

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00:05:48.070 --> 00:05:56.899

Fabiola Navarro: Extremely high volume. And so they kind of have, like their own process, which doesn't always happen. But they were pretty unique, and everything so.

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00:05:56.900 --> 00:05:57.390

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:05:57.390 --> 00:05:59.699

Fabiola Navarro: They had, like their own, almost like

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00:05:59.940 --> 00:06:03.270

Fabiola Navarro: their own way, to route the candidates through it, especially because.

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00:06:03.490 --> 00:06:08.829

Fabiola Navarro: as an example, like the next one they were able to move candidates to higher

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00:06:09.290 --> 00:06:22.093

Fabiola Navarro: or the background check results came back. Where for the Us. That wasn't a thing that it had to have all of the statuses back in order to even move them forward. So there was a little bit more flexibility for for the India population on this one.

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00:06:23.080 --> 00:06:25.120

Fabiola Navarro: but yeah, this was this was Lowe's.

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00:06:25.712 --> 00:06:31.607

Fabiola Navarro: Okay, yeah. So here Lowe's plans to create a start date application work to extend

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00:06:34.240 --> 00:06:41.100

Fabiola Navarro: future specified roles would access that start day correction, app, select the candidate, new hire, and start date

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00:06:42.020 --> 00:06:54.229

Fabiola Navarro: changes to India, new hire start dates, should update, rescind higher, revise the offer generate new offer letter dates, but it was even more detailed from that right like it was going back and actually updating.

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00:06:55.620 --> 00:06:56.150

David Denham: It's gone

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00:06:56.150 --> 00:07:08.869

David Denham: back updating the offer. Yeah, yeah, yeah, I had heard similar, I think before from, I think from another another customer gap that was identified, that

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00:07:09.330 --> 00:07:22.660

David Denham: that pattern of wanting to go back and update the offer even after hire was made. And then the background check continuing into, you know, after they've been hired. That seems very unique to India.

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00:07:22.660 --> 00:07:23.050

David Denham: Exactly.

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00:07:23.050 --> 00:07:25.700

David Denham: Not something I've heard somewhere else. So that's yeah.

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00:07:26.710 --> 00:07:30.380

Fabiola Navarro: Sure it's yeah. It's interesting how they're like, let's keep moving forward. But then.

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00:07:30.380 --> 00:07:30.750

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:07:30.750 --> 00:07:34.339

Fabiola Navarro: Changes. We don't want to go back. We want it to update everything.

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00:07:34.670 --> 00:07:38.319

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, yeah, I mean, it kind of makes sense. But yeah.

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00:07:38.320 --> 00:07:45.430

David Denham: Yeah. Yeah. And I just wonder, like, is that just the volumes that they're getting like that? They just need to keep keep them keep them flowing through, and then.

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00:07:45.430 --> 00:07:46.030

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah.

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00:07:46.030 --> 00:07:48.289

David Denham: Something is flagged. They'll, you know.

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00:07:48.290 --> 00:07:48.769

Fabiola Navarro: On my phone.

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00:07:48.770 --> 00:07:49.350

David Denham: He's.

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00:07:49.350 --> 00:07:52.030

Fabiola Navarro: At least with these guys, I would say, yeah, like they were

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00:07:52.410 --> 00:08:00.549

Fabiola Navarro: all about. Let's get these people in kind of we'll figure it out if it needs to be figured out, if something needs to change but we need to put someone in that seat.

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00:08:01.505 --> 00:08:03.380

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, for sure.

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00:08:03.520 --> 00:08:09.209

Fabiola Navarro: And then let me see, yeah. And I guess that kind of goes with the next one, which is like moving candidates

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00:08:09.520 --> 00:08:15.350

Fabiola Navarro: forward, moving to higher before those results came back. So they didn't really, that wasn't like a

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00:08:16.560 --> 00:08:25.999

Fabiola Navarro: a validation or conditional rule to prevent them from moving forward. Where, for the Us. Like, I was saying, it was checking for very specific background check statuses.

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00:08:26.120 --> 00:08:30.490

Fabiola Navarro: but for India was kind of like everyone go through to hire.

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00:08:30.730 --> 00:08:53.990

David Denham: Hmm, yeah, yeah, no, that that's definitely a a unique one. And just curious. It did. I'm not sure if they mentioned anything around like the background check integrations we have like, just in terms of like, you know, any any any gaps? Maybe with the integrations we have or you know where they satisfied with the the current integrations that are available in India.

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00:08:54.770 --> 00:08:59.479

Fabiola Navarro: So I'm trying to remember. I think they were satisfied, maybe, with, like

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00:09:00.050 --> 00:09:24.729

Fabiola Navarro: the integration itself, it was more where we were getting a lot of pushback was more, and this is also, for the Us, too, was more, being able to easily reinitiate a background check like they kept saying, they want a button. They just want a button to easily reinitiate it. Everybody wants that easy button right? And so we had to build into the process basically a move forward option to go through it again.

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00:09:25.143 --> 00:09:41.470

Fabiola Navarro: And then, even in our condition rules, we were actually preventing people from going to ready for hire, at least in the Us. Like, I said, with those statuses. So it needed to read the most recent ones. Accurately, number one and number 2. They were also using

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00:09:41.630 --> 00:09:56.060

Fabiola Navarro: parallel stages for a drug screen and a background check. So there was already a lot of complexities around, just like the process. So I think, for India. They didn't have the drug screen, but they still wanted to easily be able to

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00:09:56.240 --> 00:10:00.640

Fabiola Navarro: reinitiate, move people back. So it was more process than the integration.

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00:10:00.820 --> 00:10:05.201

David Denham: Gotcha. Okay, no, that's that's that's that's good to know.

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00:10:05.890 --> 00:10:23.089

David Denham: okay, yeah. No. I think that makes sense on the on the background check like. So it sounds like it's just having that increased flexibility in terms of when it can how far the background check can go. And then being able to like you were saying like, have some sort of like a refresh option, or something like that.

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00:10:23.090 --> 00:10:23.850

Fabiola Navarro: Exactly.

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00:10:23.850 --> 00:10:32.540

David Denham: To? Yeah, yeah, okay. And how? Just out of curiosity, how did you is that something you're able to implement in terms of like giving them that type of option.

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00:10:32.730 --> 00:10:37.400

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah. Oh, my gosh, this is probably like the most complex part of the process, because

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00:10:38.250 --> 00:10:45.190

Fabiola Navarro: in addition to us building these condition, basically, well, I guess. Let me take a step back. So the 1st thing we have to do is build

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00:10:46.550 --> 00:10:59.749

Fabiola Navarro: the business process so that it could go for India to 1 1 vendor, one integration right? And then for us another vendor. So then we had all the background check packages. We were trying to default, those

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00:11:00.050 --> 00:11:02.599

Fabiola Navarro: for the right vendor and also for the right

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00:11:02.790 --> 00:11:28.319

Fabiola Navarro: stage. So if it was drug screen, it had to be a drug screen package. If it was background. It had to be so. That was already one complex part. Then we had to build those move forward options for both reinitiating drug screen reinitiating background check, but they also still had to be in. Allow for them to go in parallel. And there were so many different scenarios like, maybe you're just reinitiating the background check. Maybe you're just reinitiating drug. Maybe both.

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00:11:28.320 --> 00:11:28.860

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:11:29.189 --> 00:11:34.130

Fabiola Navarro: And then, on top of our ready for hire, move forward options. We also had

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00:11:34.660 --> 00:11:39.919

Fabiola Navarro: the craziest condition rules that we're checking for all these pieces

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00:11:40.090 --> 00:11:45.440

Fabiola Navarro: depending on the country, and then within the Us. For example, it was so detailed.

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00:11:45.650 --> 00:11:47.518

Fabiola Navarro: so there were so many scenarios.

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00:11:47.830 --> 00:11:50.720

David Denham: I'd imagine that Bp setup was. It was very

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00:11:50.720 --> 00:11:54.409

David Denham: oh, my gosh, yes! And then they had also.

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00:11:55.375 --> 00:11:59.550

Fabiola Navarro: Automations, that if the person was

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00:11:59.900 --> 00:12:04.600

Fabiola Navarro: eligible to be moved forward into ready for hire, that the an integration would pick them up and move them.

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00:12:04.730 --> 00:12:09.789

Fabiola Navarro: because the ASR. At that point you couldn't. You couldn't kick it off with all of those.

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00:12:10.400 --> 00:12:11.040

David Denham: I mean.

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00:12:12.320 --> 00:12:16.519

Fabiola Navarro: Condition rules, because right? The background check. And this is the tricky part with ASR

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00:12:16.800 --> 00:12:17.440

David Denham: Yay!

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00:12:17.850 --> 00:12:28.980

Fabiola Navarro: Since that background check comes back at different points. There's no trigger for that, ASR, right? So an integration had to grab those candidates and move them forward. Yeah. So it's so crazy. We got.

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00:12:28.980 --> 00:12:52.729

David Denham: Sounds very complex. Yeah, yeah, okay, no, that that. Well, it makes sense. But it's obviously yeah, it's obviously a lot of complexity there. And yeah, just the last question it was. It was just to your point number 4 in what you'd sent. I was curious about the the documents collecting documents from candidates, and I think you mentioned stuff that shouldn't be stored in in workday as well.

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00:12:53.230 --> 00:12:58.209

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, they were collecting. I'm gonna see if I can find the exact list. But it was.

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00:12:58.760 --> 00:13:15.000

Fabiola Navarro: I think, like 4 or 5, maybe even more documents from the candidate, and it was like your past pay stubs a little bit more information on your id cause. They have different, you know they obviously have different ids than some of those other countries, but it was

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00:13:15.150 --> 00:13:24.939

Fabiola Navarro: so many documents that they had to request from the candidate, and they needed to store it. They needed to collect it, and we tried to push back, you know, like it shouldn't be stored in here. Maybe there's a different way.

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00:13:24.940 --> 00:13:25.330

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:13:25.330 --> 00:13:31.659

Fabiola Navarro: They had to. So we ended up building it into the process. And I think we did.

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00:13:32.270 --> 00:13:36.719

Fabiola Navarro: I'll have to double check my notes, but I'm pretty sure we did. Some move forward options.

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00:13:36.830 --> 00:13:42.400

Fabiola Navarro: and we also use maybe a questionnaire with an attachment question.

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00:13:43.260 --> 00:13:43.870

David Denham: You too.

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00:13:43.870 --> 00:13:44.500

Fabiola Navarro: To collect.

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00:13:44.500 --> 00:13:46.340

David Denham: Okay, so we have to get.

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00:13:46.340 --> 00:13:48.120

Fabiola Navarro: Pretty creative with that, too.

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00:13:48.420 --> 00:13:55.311

David Denham: Okay, you know. Yeah, I was just curious. If you'd use something like review documents, attachments. But it sounds like questionnaire

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00:13:55.640 --> 00:14:02.230

Fabiola Navarro: That's what I'm trying to remember. Let me see if I can find cause it it. Maybe it was just a review document. I think

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00:14:02.590 --> 00:14:04.360

Fabiola Navarro: I'm trying to remember.

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00:14:05.090 --> 00:14:07.370

David Denham: Yeah, and

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00:14:08.370 --> 00:14:22.173

David Denham: but yeah, no, I I like, I think that again, I think that sounds like an interesting one. And yeah, like, I totally agree like it sounds like there's some documents there that you know. Probably you know they they probably would have been better storing somewhere else. But

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00:14:22.570 --> 00:14:27.840

Fabiola Navarro: Yes, yeah. Oh, here's here's 1 up upload photo. Was.

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00:14:28.280 --> 00:14:29.040

David Denham: Okay.

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00:14:29.530 --> 00:14:33.334

Fabiola Navarro: Was an example so like again, very unique

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00:14:34.470 --> 00:14:40.549

Fabiola Navarro: documents that they were collecting. And it was just, I think we did send them. It must have been a review documents that

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00:14:40.690 --> 00:14:48.809

Fabiola Navarro: I think we played around with a couple of different ideas, but we had a very simple, and I'll just show you this, too, actually, am I still sharing? Yeah, perfect.

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00:14:48.810 --> 00:14:49.220

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:14:50.330 --> 00:14:59.220

Fabiola Navarro: So he they had, like a very simple document, right? And then it was as part of your application. We require you to upload recent passport.

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00:14:59.420 --> 00:15:00.480

David Denham: Picture.

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00:15:00.800 --> 00:15:03.839

Fabiola Navarro: And so they would use that review. Doc. Attachment.

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00:15:04.160 --> 00:15:04.920

David Denham: Okay?

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00:15:05.220 --> 00:15:20.007

David Denham: So so again, it sounds like, potentially lots, lots of extra attachment steps for the for them to collect those those documents. Yeah, that makes sense. So lots of lots of configuration there.

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00:15:20.690 --> 00:15:41.069

David Denham: just yeah. I suppose in terms of those 4 like, was there one that stood out as being the most I suppose, important for for them in terms of of having and like would have been that that offer, one that that was the 1st one you mentioned, or and what was the most critical one for for them to to maybe have first.st

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00:15:41.340 --> 00:15:56.759

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, I would probably say, yeah, the offer compensation one because the other 3. I hadn't heard as much from other clients. But the the compensation one I've heard on every project that India is included on.

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00:15:56.760 --> 00:16:19.400

David Denham: Interesting. Okay, yeah, that's that's useful. Yeah, no. That's I think that's very useful. So yeah, just to just to give us a little bit of a sense of of priority. And yeah, I'm sorry. I'm just conscious of your time. And Fabiola, is, is there anything else, I suppose? Yeah, any other kind of pain, points, or opportunities that you you would have heard of. And you know, throughout those engagements.

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00:16:20.877 --> 00:16:26.240

Fabiola Navarro: Let me see, I don't think so. I'll just like go through

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00:16:26.570 --> 00:16:33.420

Fabiola Navarro: my notes again. And I actually did reach out to the recruiting product leads, and I know

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00:16:34.840 --> 00:16:43.989

Fabiola Navarro: one of the product leads knew about a consultant that was working currently with an India customer. So I have a name I don't know if that would be helpful to. In the meantime, while I look through my notes.

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00:16:44.220 --> 00:16:56.260

David Denham: Yeah, if you could. I did talk to one consultant. I think he was working with genpact. But yeah, if you could send the name. Yeah. Keen to talk to.

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00:16:56.260 --> 00:16:56.600

David Denham: Yeah.

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00:16:56.600 --> 00:17:06.973

David Denham: who are kind of hands on at the moment with the with customers. So that'd be super useful. And yeah, anything else that comes up in in your notes that you might be able to share, would really appreciate that as well.

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00:17:07.220 --> 00:17:07.690

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah.

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00:17:07.690 --> 00:17:26.780

David Denham: Because I think that just helps me build a bit of a picture as to where where the pain points are, you know, maybe where where we should focus as well. And you know, when I when I kind of go through the rest of the research and kind of collate everything. So so yeah, anything else you could be able to share, or any any names as well, would be super useful. Fabiola.

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00:17:26.780 --> 00:17:33.040

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, yeah, of course. And I'm gonna I just found his name and it maybe it actually might be the same person you talked to. David.

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00:17:35.180 --> 00:17:36.630

David Denham: It's yeah up to date.

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00:17:36.630 --> 00:18:02.099

David Denham: But yeah, yeah, he was. He was a wealth of information as well from the Gen. Pact work. He's been doing very interesting. I think. You know, they were very much a professional services and project based. So they had some interesting use cases in terms of sourcing internal workers in in high volume. So, yeah, hearing different things, you know, from different customers. But

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00:19:50.110 --> 00:19:54.184

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, for sure. I'll see what I can if I can find anything else out. But that's an interesting one, for sure.

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00:19:54.370 --> 00:20:18.169

David Denham: It is. Yeah, no, it definitely has its own unique challenges. I think I'm learning in in India definitely, not things we've we heard in Japan from from the research there. So listen, Fabul. I really appreciate all that. I think again, wealth of information there, and I'll I'll go through the recording and and the notes. But yeah, like, like you say, any any other kind of follow up notes you might have would be super useful as well.

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00:20:18.340 --> 00:20:20.690

Fabiola Navarro: Yeah, for sure. I'll keep you posted. Thank you so much.

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00:20:20.690 --> 00:20:22.460

David Denham: Thanks thanks again. Bye, bye.